Articulate Training for CMASTE

Day 1: Basic Program Use and Design

Thinking About Design

Think back to the online courses that you've taken

- What did you like about them?

Thinking About Design

Think back to the online courses that you've taken

- What did you NOT like about them?

Principles of Online Learning Design

- Remember that you will not be there to help your user figure it out
- Visual distractions are annoying and impair the ability of the learner to figure out what they are supposed to be focusing on
- You can use cuing in order to help the learner know what is important at what moment
  - Arrows to point out key data
  - Highlights
  - Summarizations

Principles of Online Learning Design

- Online learning is just like managing a classroom… except you may never see or meet your students
- Therefore: Be kind to your learner **always**
  - Avoid walls of text
  - Use summaries to bring things together
  - Use dictionaries to help with difficult words (rollovers help too)
  - Consider what you might point out in person and point that out in online learning too
  - Avoid anything that might be distracting to the learner, everything should have a purpose if it’s there to be pretty: ditch it

Find some examples 10 Min

- Go out into the web and find some websites that have good design in terms of what we've discussed
- Look for:
  - lack of distraction
  - Being kind to the user
  - Managing attention well
  - Summaries
  - Easy movement around and finding what you need

The Good

- Let’s look at your examples and critique them
  - What do we like?
  - What might we change?
  - Is there anything that you love enough that it would change how you will design your course?

Find some more examples 10 Min

- Find some examples of bad design from big name websites
  - No fair picking on Jim Bob’s website, find some big names
- Some websites might be terrible but we can glean from them what not to do in our own work

The Bad

- Let’s review the websites that we just didn’t find well designed
  - What are the issues that we see?
  - How does that tell us what to avoid in our own work?
  - Does the website need a big change to fix it?
  - Why do you think they have the design problem?